

CLAT GK - Test 09

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Eight High Courts get new Chief Justices

The Centre notified the appointment of Chief Justices for eight High Courts on 5 September 2026. Law Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal announced the appointments on X, saying the President had made them in exercise of constitutional powers.

The appointments followed Supreme Court Collegium recommendations made in August 2026. Four of the names had been recommended for the High Courts of Calcutta, Bombay, Patna and Punjab and Haryana. Among the appointees, Justice V. Kameswar Rao, a Delhi High Court judge, was named Chief Justice of the Patna High Court. Justice Ravindra Vithalrao Ghuge was named for Calcutta, and Justice Mahesh Chandra Tripathi, of the Allahabad High Court, for Bombay.

Justice Ashwani Kumar Mishra was named Chief Justice of the Punjab and Haryana High Court. Justice Krushna Ram Mohapatra, of the Orissa High Court, was named for Chhattisgarh. Justice Alpesh Yeshvant Kogje, of the Gujarat High Court, was named for Madhya Pradesh, and Justice Pushpendra Singh Bhati, of the Rajasthan High Court, for Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh.

The Collegium's recommendations came as several High Courts were being run by acting Chief Justices after retirements and elevations to the Supreme Court.

Q1. Under which Article of the Constitution is every High Court judge appointed by the President through a warrant under his hand and seal?

- (A) Article 216
- (B) Article 219
- (C) Article 217
- (D) Article 214

Q2. Which Article empowers the President, after consulting the Chief Justice of India, to transfer a High Court judge from one High Court to another?

- (A) Article 216
- (B) Article 219
- (C) Article 222
- (D) Article 224

Q3. Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Article 129	A. Power of a High Court to issue writs for enforcing fundamental rights or for any other purpose
II. Article 226	B. Appointment and posting of district judges in a State
III. Article 227	C. Supreme Court declared to be a court of record
IV. Article 233	D. Superintendence over all courts and tribunals in the High Court's territory

Choose the correct matching:

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A

Q4. Assertion (A): Parliament may by law increase the number of judges of the Supreme Court beyond the number initially fixed in the Constitution.

Reason (R): Supreme Court judges hold office until the age of 65 years.

- (A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (B) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A)
- (C) (A) is true but (R) is false
- (D) (A) is false but (R) is true

Q5. Statement I. Under Article 224, the President may appoint additional judges of a High Court for a term of up to five years.

Statement II. Under Article 223, the Governor of a State appoints the acting Chief Justice of a High Court.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) Both I and II
- (D) Neither I nor II

Q6. Statement I. Under Article 124, Supreme Court judges are appointed by the President.

Statement II. A Supreme Court judge may resign only with the prior approval of Parliament.

Statement III. Parliament may by law provide the authority and manner for determining a Supreme Court judge's age.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) All of the above

Portugal Joins the Artemis Accords

Portugal became the 60th signatory to the Artemis Accords in January 2026. Helena Canhão, Portugal's Secretary of State for Science and Innovation, signed the accords on behalf of the country on 11

January. A ceremony in Lisbon was attended by John J. Arrigo, the United States Ambassador to Portugal, and Hugo Costa, executive director of the Portuguese Space Agency. The event coincided with a semi-annual meeting on cooperation between the United States and Portugal. NASA Administrator Jared Isaacman welcomed Portugal as the newest signatory. Arrigo called Portugal's decision a meaningful step forward for responsible space exploration. Costa said that 2026 is the year humans return to the Moon, which will mark the beginning of a new era of space exploration, recalling Portuguese explorers such as Magellan.

Q7. Who was the commander of NASA's Artemis II crewed mission?

- (A) Buzz Aldrin
- (B) Neil Armstrong
- (C) Eugene Cernan
- (D) Reid Wiseman

Q8. Which of the following countries was NOT among the original signatories of the Artemis Accords?

- (A) Japan
- (B) Luxembourg
- (C) Italy
- (D) France

Q9. Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Year in which the Artemis Accords were launched	A. 1967
II. Year of the Outer Space Treaty on which the Accords' principles are grounded	B. 2020
III. Number of original signatories of the Artemis Accords	C. 8
IV. Number of principles in the Artemis Accords	D. 10

Choose the correct matching:

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C

Q10. Assertion (A): The Artemis Accords are a legally binding treaty that the UN Security Council enforces against any signatory that breaks them.

Reason (R): The Artemis Accords are non-binding and provide no formal means of enforcement.

- (A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (B) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A)
- (C) (A) is true but (R) is false
- (D) (A) is false but (R) is true

Q11. Statement 1. The Artemis II mission lifted off on 1 April 2026.

Statement 2. Artemis II was a crewed flight around the Moon that did not land on it.

Statement 3. Artemis II landed astronauts on the lunar surface.

Statement 4. Artemis II launched from Vandenberg Space Force Base in California.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All four

Q12. Statement I. The North Atlantic Treaty was signed on 4 April 1949.

Statement II. The North Atlantic Treaty entered into force on 1 January 1950.

Statement III. Portugal was one of the original signatories of the North Atlantic Treaty.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) All of the above

Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill defeated in Lok Sabha

On 17 April 2026, the Lok Sabha defeated the Constitution (One Hundred and Thirty-first Amendment) Bill, 2026. The bill received 298 votes in favour and 230 against, so more members voted for it than against, yet it was still defeated. The bill was tied to a fresh delimitation exercise, and the government had presented it as a way to bring women's reservation into effect sooner.

The bill proposed raising the strength of the Lok Sabha from 543 to 850 seats, with up to 815 members from the states and 35 from Union Territories. It sought to base the revised seat distribution on the 2011 Census. It also proposed amending Articles 82 and 334A so that delimitation was no longer tied to the first census after 2026, and the one-third reservation for women in the Lok Sabha and state assemblies could follow delimitation.

Opposition parties argued that increasing seats on the basis of the 2011 Census would reduce the representation of southern and north-eastern states.

After the defeat, the government withdrew two companion bills: the Delimitation Bill, 2026 and the Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026.

Q13. Assertion (A): The Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026 was defeated in the Lok Sabha on 17 April 2026 even though more members voted for it than against it.

Reason (R): A constitutional amendment must be passed by a special majority: a majority of the House's total membership and a two-thirds majority of the members present and voting.

- (A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (B) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A)
- (C) (A) is true but (R) is false
- (D) (A) is false but (R) is true

Q14. Which Constitution Amendment Act of 2023 provided for reserving one-third of seats for women in the Lok Sabha and State Legislative Assemblies?

- (A) 106th Amendment
- (B) 105th Amendment
- (C) 103rd Amendment
- (D) 101st Amendment

Q15. Under Article 324 of the Constitution, which body is vested with the superintendence, direction and control of the preparation of electoral rolls and the conduct of elections to Parliament and State Legislatures?

- (A) Union Public Service Commission
- (B) Comptroller and Auditor General
- (C) Finance Commission
- (D) Election Commission of India

Q16. Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Article 81	A. Composition of the House of the People
II. Article 169	B. Creation or abolition of Legislative Councils
III. Article 170	C. Composition of State Legislative Assemblies
IV. Article 239AA	D. Legislative Assembly of Delhi

Choose the correct matching:

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C

Q17. Statement I. The Delimitation Bill, 2026 was introduced to repeal and replace the Delimitation Act, 1952.

Statement II. The Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026 extended its changes only to Ladakh.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) Both I and II
- (D) Neither I nor II

Q18. Statement I. A Money Bill can be introduced only in the Lok Sabha.

Statement II. The Rajya Sabha must return a Money Bill within 14 days, with or without recommendations.

Statement III. The Rajya Sabha has the power to reject a Money Bill outright.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) All of the above

2026 Pulitzer Prizes announced

The Pulitzer Prize Board announced the 2026 Pulitzer Prizes on 4 May 2026. In journalism, the Minnesota Star Tribune staff won Breaking News Reporting, and Mark Lamster of The Dallas Morning News won Criticism. Aaron Parsley of Texas Monthly won Feature Writing. The Washington Post won Public Service, with The Wall Street Journal and the Chicago Tribune as finalists. The New York Times staff won Investigative Reporting, with ProPublica's Debbie Cenziper, Megan Rose and Brandon Roberts as finalists. Reuters staff won National Reporting.

In the arts, Bess Wohl won the Drama prize for Liberation, a play that examines the legacy of the consciousness-raising feminist groups of the 1970s. Daniel Kraus won the Fiction prize for Angel Down, a World War I novel told in a single sentence. The judges called it a stylistic tour-de-force that blends allegory, magical realism and science fiction into a cohesive whole. Jill Lepore won the History prize for We the People: A History of the U.S. Constitution.

Drama and fiction winners each receive a \$15,000 award.

Q19. Which US university administers the Pulitzer Prizes?

- (A) Princeton University
- (B) Yale University
- (C) Harvard University
- (D) Columbia University

Q20. In which year did the publisher Joseph Pulitzer, whose estate endowed the Pulitzer Prizes, die?

- (A) 1911
- (B) 1917
- (C) 1923
- (D) 1898

Q21. In which year did a former US president file a defamation lawsuit in a Florida court against members of the Pulitzer Prize board over its refusal to rescind the 2018 prizes for Russia-related reporting?

- (A) 2022
- (B) 2020
- (C) 2024
- (D) 2018

Q22. Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Pulitzer Prize	A. India
II. Booker Prize	B. France
III. Prix Goncourt	C. United Kingdom
IV. Sahitya Akademi Award	D. United States

Choose the correct matching:

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B

Q23. Assertion (A): Daniel Kraus won the 2026 Pulitzer Prize for Fiction for the novel Angel Down.

Reason (R): The Pulitzer Prize for Fiction is open only to authors who are not citizens of the United States.

- (A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (B) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A)
- (C) (A) is true but (R) is false
- (D) (A) is false but (R) is true

Q24. Statement I. Joseph Pulitzer was born in the United States.

Statement II. The Sahitya Akademi was inaugurated in 1954.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) Both I and II
- (D) Neither I nor II

Semicon 2.0 and Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme

The Union Cabinet on 15 July 2026 approved seven decisions with a combined outlay of about ■2.19 lakh crore. Two electronics schemes made up most of that amount.

The first is Semicon 2.0, the second phase of the India Semiconductor Mission, with an outlay of ■1,27,500 crore. The government expects it to draw about ■4 lakh crore in investment and to support semiconductor production worth ■2 lakh crore during the scheme period. Its six focus areas are chip design, equipment and materials, new fabs, assembly and packaging, research and development, and talent. Support therefore extends beyond chip fabrication.

The second is the Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme, with a budgetary outlay of ■62,500 crore for FY 2026-27 to FY 2030-31. It has two target segments: manufacturing in India, and Indian mobile phone brands. Its aim is to scale up domestic mobile phone production.

Together, the two schemes come to about ■1.9 lakh crore. The same meeting also cleared highway projects and urea-sector decisions.

Q25. What was the initial outlay of the first phase of the India Semiconductor Mission (ISM 1.0), approved by the Union Cabinet?

- (A) ■10,000 crore
- (B) ■50,000 crore
- (C) ■65,000 crore
- (D) ■76,000 crore

Q26. Under Article 280 of the Constitution, the Finance Commission is constituted by the President at the expiration of every how many years, unless an earlier time is considered necessary?

- (A) Three years
- (B) Seven years
- (C) Ten years
- (D) Five years

Q27. Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Article 112	A. Contingency Fund of India
II. Article 266	B. Annual Financial Statement
III. Article 267	C. Comptroller and Auditor General
IV. Article 148	D. Consolidated Fund of India

Choose the correct matching:

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B

Q28. Assertion (A): The first phase of the India Semiconductor Mission was approved by the Union Cabinet in December 2021.

Reason (R): The India Semiconductor Mission functions under the Ministry of Finance.

- (A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (B) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A)
- (C) (A) is true but (R) is false
- (D) (A) is false but (R) is true

Q29. Statement I. Under Article 75(3), the Council of Ministers is collectively responsible to the House of the People (Lok Sabha).

Statement II. A Money Bill may be returned by the Rajya Sabha with its recommendations within a period of fourteen days.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) Both I and II
- (D) Neither I nor II

Q30. Statement I. Article 265 provides that no tax may be levied or collected except by authority of law.

Statement II. Article 265 allows a tax to be collected on the strength of executive circulars alone.

Statement III. Under Article 74(1), the President must act in accordance with the advice of the Council of Ministers, subject to the proviso on reconsideration.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) All of the above